

Chrome OS has been known to confuse and confound a variety of people - from naysayers who believe it's the biggest mistake made by Google to evangelists who can't seem to get over its functionality. In reality, the Chrome OS is a hybrid product that works more like an appliance like a smartphone rather than a traditional computer.

In its purest form within a Chromebook, it benefits from customised hardware/firmware that makes it perform at a much better level when compared to other netbooks/laptops of similar design. But it comes with its own baggage of restrictions that make users of traditional operating systems scratch their heads wondering if its a computer at all. The one thing that needs to be cleared up outright is that Chrome OS isn't an internet browser machine made exclusively for the internet. In fact, its something more subtle and fascinating.

Understand: Chrome OS vs. Traditional OS

Since the inception of graphical user interface operating systems like Microsoft's Windows or Apple's Mac OS X we as users have developed an expectation of what an operating system does. In our common experiences, operating systems are the platform on which we undertake all our computer based activities and as the decades have gone by it has remained one of the firm foundations of the user experience.

Traditional operating systems are intended to be our primary interface between our tasks and our hardware capabilities. They organise, collate and mediate the vast array of media, tools, applications and data that we need to work and play. The Chrome OS however seems to do away with many of these fundamental features such as the need to install applications on to the machine's hard disk. But this disruption of our expectations isn't all that Chrome OS is about.

A traditional operating system is built around the need for a variety of hardware components to symbiotically work as per our instructions

